



PROCEDURE

National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS) Coordinator

Scope (Staff):	All staff
Scope (Area):	CAMHS-wide

Child Safe Organisation Statement of Commitment

CAHS commits to being a child safe organisation by applying the National Principles for Child Safe Organisations. This is a commitment to a strong culture supported by robust policies and procedures to reduce the likelihood of harm to children and young people.

This document should be read in conjunction with this [disclaimer](#)

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Aim

Describes coordination of the National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS) within the Infant Child and Adolescent Mental Health Service (CAMHS) and the role and responsibilities of the Coordinator NDIS. This procedure provides information, support and guidance to clinical staff intersecting with this role.

Risk

To CAMHS:

- CAMHS clinical staff lack clarity of understanding the role and responsibilities of the Coordinator NDIS resulting in underutilisation, missed or delayed opportunities for enhanced support and poorer outcomes for clients interfacing with the NDIS.
- Provision of services that do not appropriately support the needs of clients with a disability accessing CAMHS services.

Background

The Coordinator NDIS is a clinical consultative role that provides advice and consultation to CAMHS clinicians on individual client referrals related to the NDIS, develops and inputs into CAMHS policy related to the NDIS, and provides training and support to build the capacity of CAMHS clinicians in relation to the NDIS.

The role was established in 2023 following the identification of the need for a targeted and dedicated NDIS (and other disability) interface for CAMHS clinical staff to support clients and their families to access and maintain appropriate disability supports

The Coordinator NDIS role offers coordination of access and interface for disability supports and services, including the NDIS, for CAMHS clients and families. The Coordinator NDIS provides expert knowledge to CAMHS leadership and clinical staff regarding disability access, eligibility, supports and services, including psychosocial support services. The role also includes liaison with other agencies, community organisations and service providers to strengthen collaboration and engagement with CAMHS. The scope of the role extends across all CAMHS Networks; CAMHS North, East, South and Central;

Key background information regarding NDIS and Health:

- The NDIS will fund personalised supports related to people's disability support needs, unless those supports are part of another service system's universal service obligation (for example, meeting the health, education, housing, or safety needs of all Australians) or covered by reasonable adjustment (as required under the [Disability Discrimination Act 1992 \(legislation.gov.au\)](https://www.legislation.gov.au/idx/doc/other/act/1992/1992-0001/act.html) or similar legislation in jurisdictions).
- CAMHS aims to implement recommendations from the Council of Australian Governments (COAG) Bilateral Agreement, in particular the [The Applied Principles and Tables of Support to Determine Responsibilities NDIS and other service | Department of Social Services, Australian Government \(dss.gov.au\)](https://www.dss.gov.au/governance-and-structure/bilateral-agreement). The Bilateral Agreement was initially endorsed in 2015 and outlines the States and Federal responsibilities in relation to funding for disability related services and supports.
- The Bilateral Agreement states (2015, p. 60):
 - "The health system will be responsible for the treatment of mental illness, including acute inpatient, ambulatory, rehabilitation/recovery and early intervention, including clinical support for child and adolescent developmental needs.

- The NDIS will be responsible for ongoing psychosocial recovery supports that focus on a person's functional capacity including those that enable people with mental illness or a psychiatric condition to undertake activities of daily living and participate in the community and in social and economic life. This may also include provision of family and carer supports to support them in their carer role, and family therapy, as they may facilitate the person's ability to participate in the community and in social and economic life.
- The NDIS and the mental health system will work closely together at the local level to plan and coordinate streamlined care for individuals requiring both mental health and disability services recognising that both inputs may be required at the same time or that there is a need to ensure a smooth transition from one to the other."

Definitions

Child / Young Person: a child or young person less than 18 years of age who is in receipt of services from CAMHS.

Clinical staff: Term used to include psychologists, case managers, doctors, psychiatrists, social workers, nurses, occupational therapists and other professionally accredited staff within Mental Health that take primary or direct responsibility for a mental health client.

Council of Australian Governments (COAG): is the primary intergovernmental forum in Australia. It consists of the federal government, the governments of the six states and two mainland territories and the Australian Local Government Association, managing governmental relations within Australia's federal system within the scope of matters of national importance.

Disability related supports: services, assistance and products required by a client to address the impact of a disability. Supports can include mainstream services, assistance from family, carers, friends and NDIS funded items such as supports to access a paid carer in the community.

Functional ability: an ability to which an individual can effectively participate in or complete a task (much more than a person experiencing difficulty with task completion). This is considered in an age-appropriate context.

Health Liaison Officer (HLO): the HLO is an National Disability Insurance Agency (NDIA) employee who works within the Hospital Interface Branch. A HLO is allocated to all public hospitals across Australia and they work with hospital inpatient teams to resolve issues relating to an NDIS participant (or potential participant) where they are experiencing NDIS related barriers to discharge.

National Disability Insurance Agency (NDIA): The NDIA is the federal government agency that delivers the NDIS.

National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS): The NDIA delivers the NDIS to people with disability who meet the access criteria set out in the NDIS Act 2013 (including Early Intervention pathways). The NDIS is a lifelong insurance scheme

which delivers an individualized plan with reasonable and necessary supports to the client.

NDIS Portfolio Holder: a clinical staff member from each CAMHS service nominated in the portfolio of NDIS. The clinical staff member would have an interest in the disability/mental health interface and the processes of engaging with the NDIS.

NDIS Community of Practice: a collective of NDIS Portfolio Holders from across CAMHS which meet regularly to share and receive information, and escalate issues relating to the NDIS and/or disability to the Coordinator NDIS.

Psychosocial support services: refers to support provided to enable people to live or remain in the community as opposed to clinical treatment, medication or inpatient care. Psychosocial support can refer to support provided by non-clinical but trained mental health workers and peer workers, and as one to one support or in groups. This type of support may be considered within the range of supports offered in an NDIS plan.

Roles and Responsibilities

Coordinator NDIS

Function	Activities
In scope	
NDIS processes	- Develops and maintains resources to support CAMHS clinical staff to transition clients to the NDIS, and/or facilitate collaborative practice where both services maintain involvement in the client's care.
Staff consultation	- Liaises with CAMHS clinical staff about their clients and individual cases and how they may or may not intersect with the NDIS. - Guides clinical staff on the appropriate process to follow to achieve optimal client outcomes. This can include reviewing clinical and NDIS documentation and providing direction and/or feedback.
Training	- Develops and delivers relevant NDIS training to CAMHS services, in consultation with CAMHS Learning and Development.
Policy	- Develops policies/procedures/guidelines relevant to NDIS and disability services, in consultation with CAMHS Policy.
Sector engagement	Liaises with other agencies, community organisations and service providers to strengthen collaboration and engagement with CAMHS. These include but are not limited to;

Function	Activities
	- Within WA Health, liaising with other NDIS Leads in the wider WA Health system and being guided by Department of Health Intergovernmental Relations and Strategic Program Support Strategy and Governance: Disability. - Working collaboratively with the NDIA itself, and in particular with the HLO assigned to Perth Children's Hospital (PCH). - NDIA's Partners in the Community, non-government organisations which were successful in tendering for contracted NDIA deliverables such as Mission Australia, Advanced Personnel Management (APM) and Wanslea for the Early Childhood Early Intervention (ECEI) Pathway. - NDIS Providers who can be funded through an NDIS Plan.
Data	- Collects data covering demographic and clinical information of CAMHS clients accessing and interfacing with the NDIS.
Out of scope	
Client facing	- The Coordinator NDIS does not interact directly with CAMHS clients or families, except by rare exception in consultation with relevant Head of Department.
Writing assessments/ NDIS documentation	- The Coordinator NDIS does not write individual assessments or NDIS documentation for a CAMHS client or family. The Coordinator NDIS may review and provide feedback on current documentation and guide CAMHS staff to complete relevant documentation.

Service Managers

- Work with Coordinator NDIS to consider identification of NDIS champions within their team to assist in building local capacity and assist in facilitating communication of key information. This role could include:
 - Disseminate information to colleagues within their service in relation to NDIS process, letter templates, forms etc.
 - Attend bi-monthly meetings with the NDIS 'Community of Practice' to report on opportunities and challenges within their service in relation to the NDIS Interface
 - Become a first point of contact within their service for NDIS related matters
- Information distribution as required
- Work with Coordinator NDIS to schedule required training with relevant staff

Clinicians

- How to request consultation with Coordinator NDIS:
 1. Provide client information (client name and UMRN).
 2. Outline reason for consultation request (e.g. obtain NDIS plan, advice/consultation in completing NDIS processes, expedite NDIS access request or plan reassessment, assistance to resolve NDIS service interface issues).
 3. Complete NDIS Consent to Act and Share Your Information Form. This form allows CAMHS (with the coordinator NDIS details as the key representative) to exchange information with NDIS on the participants' behalf. The NDIS Consent form can be found on this page: [Paediatric Mental Health and the NDIS](#)
 4. Complete the CAMHS [Consent for Exchange of Information with External Agencies Form](#) (MR510.07).
 5. Email above information (excluding CAMHS consent form) to CAMHS.ndis@health.wa.gov.au where the request will be prioritised and allocated.
- For current CAMHS clients it is CAMHS' responsibility to provide "Evidence of Disability" to the NDIS for the purposes of an Access Request, upcoming Planning Meeting or a Plan Re-Assessment. The process for providing the "Evidence of Disability" is different depending on the client situations and which service the client is active with. Please see the below Work Instructions detailing the service specific procedures.
 - Inpatient mental health unit (Perth Children's Hospital 5A) [NDIA Hospital Discharge Pathway \(health.wa.gov.au\)](#)
 - CAMHS Crisis Connect (in development)
 - CAMHS North, South and East (in development)

CAMHS Executive

- Receive information and provide feedback to the Coordinator NDIS, as required:
 - Understand and respond to CAMHS service opportunities and challenges as they relate to the disability and health service interface

Sector Engagement

- Liaison with the PCH Coordinator NDIS:
 - At times there may be crossover between CAMHS and PCH services. Communication is vital to ensure that only one Coordinator NDIS is assisting the client at any given time.
 - A regular, booked meeting to discuss NDIS changes affecting the paediatric population should occur.

- Interfacing with the NDIS Health Liaison Officer (HLO):
 - Send relevant consultations via email to the HLO and include the generic HLO email address- health.liaison.officer@ndis.gov.au
 - Regular meetings with the HLO to discuss escalated cases will occur and are chaired by the HLO.
- Department of Health - Intergovernmental Relations and Community Programs, Strategy and Governance Division
 - Attend meetings set by this division as required
 - Provide feedback to this division as required
 - The Coordinator NDIS can escalate service wide concerns to this department for a coordinated response across WA Health
- Child and Adolescent Health Service (CAHS) Disability Access and Inclusion Committee (DAIC)
 - One of the two CAMHS Representatives on the Committee
 - Attend meetings on a monthly basis
 - Develop, implement, monitor and evaluate the CAHS Disability Access and Inclusion Plan (DAIP)
- Child and Adolescent Health Service NDIS Advisory Group
 - Attend meetings every quarter and represent CAMHS
 - Report on NDIS changes and how they have affected CAMHS

References and related external legislation, policies, and guidelines

[National Disability Insurance Scheme Act 2013 \(legislation.gov.au\)](http://legislation.gov.au)

The [Vancouver style](#) referencing is as per CAHS Library and Information Service.

Related CAHS internal policies, procedures and guidelines

NDIS Liaison and Process PCH Ward 5A Work Instruction

[NDIA Hospital Discharge Pathway \(health.wa.gov.au\)](http://health.wa.gov.au)

NDIS Liaison and Process CAMHS Crisis Connect Work Instruction (in development)
NDIS Liaison and Process Community and Specialised CAMHS Work Instruction (in development)
Consent Guideline
Consent for Exchange of Information with External Agencies MR510.07
CAHS Consent to Treatment (health.wa.gov.au)

Useful resources (including related forms)
The Applied Principles and Tables of Support to Determine Responsibilities NDIS and other service Department of Social Services, Australian Government (dss.gov.au). NDIS Consent Form: Paediatric Mental Health and the NDIS National Safety and Quality Health Service Standards, Second Edition National Principles for Child Safe Organisations2019.DOCX (live.com)

This document can be made available in alternative formats on request.

File Path:	CD/25/29541		
Document Owner:	ICAMHS Director Clinical Services		
Reviewer / Team:	SSAMHS, PPWG, Community CAMHS Clinics, Service Managers, CAMHS Policy Team, ICAMHS Director Clinical Services, Director ICAMHS Central		
Date First Issued:	04/12/2024	Last Reviewed:	
Amendment Dates:		Next Review Date:	04/12/2027
Approved by:	ICAMHS Director Clinical Services	Date:	10/09/2024
Endorsed by:	CAMHS Safety & Quality, Risk, Audit and Compliance Executive Committee	Date:	04/12/2024
Aboriginal Impact Statement and Declaration (ISD)		Date ISD approved:	
Standards Applicable:	NSQHS Standards:  Child Safe Principles: 1, 7, 9, 10		
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